



SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

C. B. Benson, Reena Manohar win Kochi Spice Coast Marathon



Local runners C.B. Benson and Reena Manohar won the men's and women's titles, respectively, in the Ageas Federal Life Insurance Kochi Spice Coast Marathon at the Marine Drive.

Benson (**receiving the award from Sachin Tendulkar**), who had finished second in the two previous editions, comfortably tackled the men's 42.2km in 3:00.42s on a cool, overcast morning, while Reena won the women's marathon in 4:50.06s.

"I am delighted to see so many running enthusiasts turn up so early in the morning. It's even more heartening to see so many women and elderly in the mix," said cricket great Tendulkar, the brand ambassador of Ageas Federal Life Insurance, during the awards function.

The marathon, organised by Soles of Kochi, attracted over 8,000 runners in its different formats. Several NGOs and corporates fielded teams, and Kochi Police had 126 runners, including 50 women.

Meanwhile, K.M. Sajith won the half-marathon for the third successive time, while A.K. Rama took the women's title.

STAN RAYAN

» INDIAN PLAYGROUND

SPORTOON



1 India Seniors signed off with a silver medal as it went down 165-258 to USA in the final of the 16th World Bridge Olympiad in Buenos Aires. The Indian team comprised Kamal Mukherjee, Vibhas Todi, Badal Das, Pranab Bardhan, Arun Bapat, Ravi Goenka and Girish Bijoor, who is the non-playing captain. Meanwhile, in two pairs events held alongside the final, the young Indian duo of Sanjit Dey and Binod Shaw excelled, finishing as the top performers in both events and ending their maiden international competition on a high note.

TEAM SPORTSTAR

2 The 39th edition of the National Junior Athletics Championships will be held at the Kalinga Stadium in Bhubaneswar from December 7 to 11. The event was supposed to be held from October 25 to 29 before being postponed due to the threat of cyclone in Odisha. The Athletics Federation of India (AFI) confirmed this, stating that safety and preparedness were top priorities in deciding to change the dates. With the rescheduling finalised, preparations are underway to make this a successful gathering of the nation's athletic talent at the junior level.

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